Pandelis Zembashis

CTO | Head of Engineering | AI Product & Platform Leader

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

CTO and Head of Engineering leader building AI-native products, platforms, and teams from 0 to 1 through scale across AI, fintech, mobility, and IoT. Lead product and engineering at Cosine across enterprise AI software engineering workflows and private deployment models, including VPC, on-prem, and air-gapped environments. Previously served as Head of Engineering at 11x.ai during growth from 0 to $1M ARR in under six months while scaling high-volume automation systems.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Cosine | CTO | Oct. 2023 – Present

Enterprise AI software engineering platform for high-security teams and demanding codebases.

- Lead product and engineering for an AI software engineering platform built for complex, high-security enterprise codebases.
- Define product requirements across CLI, IDE, GitHub, Jira, and Slack workflows, aligning AI capabilities with engineering execution and enterprise use cases.
- Build multi-agent and PR-based delivery patterns and private deployment support for VPC, on-prem, and fully air-gapped environments.
- Partner with frontier model providers on evaluations, benchmark positioning, and model customization, and represent Cosine through technical writing and speaking.

11x.ai | Head of Engineering | Apr. 2023 – Sep. 2023

Fastest-growing UK AI startup from 0 to $1M ARR in under six months. TechCrunch coverage.

- Scaled the codebase and engineering organization behind Alice as the company grew from 0 to $1M ARR in under six months.
- Scaled outbound email and event-driven automation systems processing millions of email chains and billions of tokens.
- Onboarded new engineers and established day-to-day operating rhythms during rapid seed-to-Series A growth.

Papaya | Technical Lead | Feb. 2022 – Mar. 2023

Marketplace and fleet platform helping electrify commercial and last-mile logistics. TechCrunch coverage.

- Led frontend delivery of a fleet management platform for light electric vehicles using Next.js, React Query, and Tailwind CSS.
- Introduced GraphQL into the Ruby on Rails backend, modernizing the API layer and improving iteration across product and engineering.
- Established development cadences and product intake processes that improved execution across engineering and product.

Weezy | Senior Software Engineer | Aug. 2021 – Jan. 2022

Rapid grocery delivery startup building warehouse, ordering, and customer systems before acquisition by Getir.

- Took over the core ordering and processing monolith in Ruby on Rails, leading day-to-day delivery and forward planning.
- Built warehouse operations systems and supporting AWS and Heroku infrastructure with a focus on scale, availability, and security.

finleap connect | Senior Software Engineer | Nov. 2020 – Aug. 2021

White-label fintech platform powering digital banking products and apps.

- Built GraphQL APIs on NestJS and cross-platform client components using React Native, Apollo, Node.js, and TypeScript.
- Led alerting and observability improvements and supported migration from ECS to Amazon Lambda.
- Delivered client-specific features across a multi-tenant fintech platform from GraphQL resolvers to customer-facing mobile screens.

IoT CONNCTD GmbH | Full Stack Engineer | Jul. 2019 – Nov. 2020
Cloud IoT platform unifying device protocols behind a GraphQL API.

- Built frontend interfaces, SDKs, and internal libraries for a cloud IoT platform exposing a unified GraphQL API across multiple device protocols.
- Designed authentication, update, and upstream synchronization flows using TypeScript, React, MobX, and Apollo GraphQL.

Substrakt | Software Developer | Aug. 2018 – Jun. 2019
Digital product agency building bespoke publishing, arts, and cultural web platforms.

- Built bespoke WordPress features, search experiences, and internal tooling for design-led client websites.
- Migrated the JavaScript toolchain from Gulp to Webpack, improving development and deployment workflows.

D4 Software | Software Engineer | Jun. 2017 – Jul. 2018
Product engineering consultancy building client platforms, tools, and cloud infrastructure.

- Delivered features across client platforms and internal tools using JavaScript and .NET.
- Maintained AWS infrastructure, serverless services, databases, and virtual machines while modernizing the frontend stack with Webpack, TypeScript, and Vue.js.

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS & SPEAKING

Articles: Multi-Agents; Enterprise Demands; Parallelising Development (2025 – Present)
Speaking: AWS Startups - The Future Of Work: invited speaker as CTO at Cosine on how GenAI changes operating models and delivery speed (2026)
Media: Directus TV - Edge Computing with Pandelis: guest on edge computing, CDNs, distributed runtimes, and modern web infrastructure (2024)

EDUCATION

Birmingham City University | Bachelor's Degree, Computer Science with Year in Industry | 2015 – 2019

AREAS OF EXPERTISE

Engineering Leadership: technical strategy, org design, hiring, operating cadence, cross-functional delivery
AI & Enterprise Platform: AI agents, developer tooling, autonomous coding agents, enterprise deployment, VPC, on-prem, air-gapped environments, model evaluation
Technologies: TypeScript, GraphQL, React, Next.js, Node.js, React Native, Ruby on Rails, Python, AWS, Kubernetes, observability, CLI tooling